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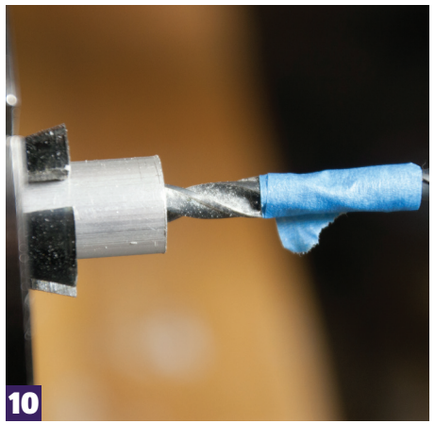
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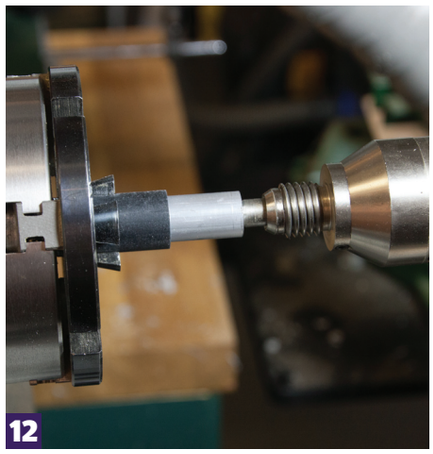
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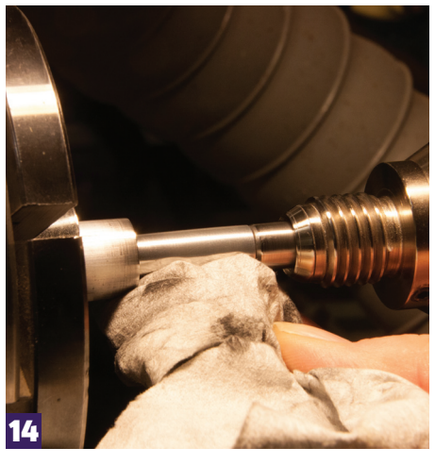
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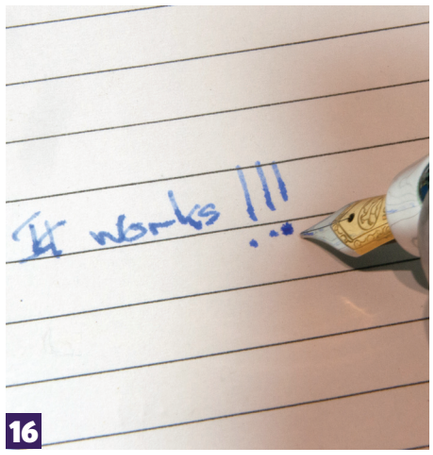

16

9 I transferred the measurements to the component and then cut to length with a hacksaw taking care to achieve a straight cut and leaving a small amount of material to be squared off on the lathe. If you're using softer material such as ebonite, the parting off could be done on the lathe with a thin parting tool

10 With the section component reversed in the chuck and having once again prepared a starter hole with a centre drill, I drilled out first to the appropriate diameter for the tap that will cut the thread for the feed – check with the nib or tap manufacturer for the correct size for your nib – and then to size and appropriate depth for the body of the feed and a few millimetres for the collar of the feed. The exact dimensions will be determined by the sizes of your chosen components. I used tape to mark the drill and gauge the depth

11 In the absence of any more sophisticated technology I tapped the internal thread by hand using my old but trusty Moore & Wright tap holder. This produced a good result but I am sure there must be better ways of doing this, although so far my research has drawn a blank. Mounting in a tailstock chuck would be one option. Once again, suggestions are welcome

12 At this point I assembled the components and tested to see that everything worked according to plan. Once I was satisfied what I had produced might actually result in a working pen, I mounted the section back in the chuck for shaping. A jam chucking arrangement seemed appropriate to prevent damage to the threads and allow access with the tools to the whole body of the component, so I drilled and tapped an offcut of acrylic material and screwed the section into it, supporting the free end with a revolving centre in the tailstock

13 Shaping was done using a round TCT cutter, carefully creating the desired shape. I created a simple straight design to suit the minimalist style of the body that will be made in the next article. Remember that the finished section must have an external diameter small enough to fit through the cap thread that you intend to use

14 The final process was to sand and polish the section. I used Abranet and Micro-Mesh abrasives and finished with Farecla polishing compounds, but there is a wide range of suitable alternatives

15 With the nib unit screwed into place and the ink converter fitted, this stage is now complete and ready to receive the body and cap that will be the subject of next month's article

16 A final test with some ink just to make sure I have a pen and not an attractive ornament! ●

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